

Perspectives

Character & Grammar Through Stories

Episode 2 – The AI Dilemma

Level: B2–C1 (IELTS Band 6.5–8.0)

Student Name: _____

Date: _____

Level: B2–C1

Learning Goals

- ✓ Read and interpret a discursive, opinion-based story
- ✓ Report statements, questions, and advice with correct backshift
- ✓ Use reporting verbs beyond 'said' — suggested, insisted, denied, admitted
- ✓ Use modals of speculation and deduction (must/might/can't/should + have + V3)
- ✓ Acquire Academic Word List vocabulary and topic collocations
- ✓ Practise IELTS-style sentence transformation and error correction
- ✓ Produce an IELTS Task 2-style discursive paragraph
- ✓ Reflect critically on honesty, trust, and institutional policy

SECTION 1 | WARM-UP — Before You Read

Part A — Prediction & Opinion Questions

Instructions: These questions require you to take a position, not just guess a plot. Answer before reading.

1. To what extent do you agree that using an AI tool to help write an assignment is fundamentally different from asking a friend or tutor for help?

2. Some people believe that as long as a student understands the final content, the method used to produce it does not matter. To what extent do you agree?

Part B — Personal Reflection

Instructions: Answer honestly from your own experience or context.

1. Have you ever used an AI tool, translation software, or another shortcut for academic work? Where do you personally draw the line?

2. Why might a student choose to hide the use of a tool rather than disclose it honestly, even if the tool itself is not banned?

SECTION 2 | MAIN STORY — Read the Story

Instructions: Read the story carefully. Underline every example of reported speech, and circle every modal of speculation or deduction (must have, might have, can't have, should have).

The AI Dilemma

Tanvir had submitted the report three days early — an unusual habit for him — and for two of those days, he felt genuinely proud of it. The assignment, a comparative analysis of network security protocols, was for his favourite course in the CSE department, and he had used an AI writing assistant to help him organise his scattered notes into something that read, he thought, like a proper research paper rather than a rushed submission.

He had not mentioned this to anyone. Using AI felt less like cheating and more like working with a very capable editor — at least, that was what he told himself when he clicked “submit.”

On Thursday afternoon, an email arrived: Dr. Farzana Elahi wanted to see him before his next class.

His friend Naeem was unhelpful in the way that only a good friend can be. “She must have noticed something,” he said, as they walked toward the department office. “Your last two assignments read completely differently from this one. Did you really think nobody would compare them?”

“I didn't think about it that carefully,” Tanvir admitted.

“Well, you should have,” Naeem said. “You can't have expected a professor who reads forty reports a semester not to notice a sudden jump in vocabulary. She might have let a small change go unnoticed. A jump like this one, though — she must have flagged it immediately.”

Dr. Elahi's office was small and lined with journals. She did not begin with an accusation. “Tanvir,” she said, “I'd like you to explain, in your own words, how the ideas in section three came together. Just talk me through your thinking.”

Tanvir hesitated. When she asked directly whether he had understood the encryption method fully before submitting it, he first denied that there was any real gap in his understanding. Then, under her calm, patient silence, he corrected himself. He admitted that he had used an AI tool to help with the report. He insisted, however, that he had used it only to organise ideas he already had and to phrase certain sections more clearly than he could have done on his own.

Dr. Elahi listened without interrupting. When he finished, she said that intention did not remove the need for honesty. She explained that the problem was not necessarily the tool itself; it was that he had presented assisted work as entirely his own, without giving her — or himself — an accurate picture of what he actually understood.

“Can you explain the encryption method in section three to me now, without the report in front of you?” she asked.

Tanvir tried. He got through the first half confidently, then stumbled. He admitted that the tool had explained that part better than he could have explained it himself, and that he had not fully checked whether he understood it before submitting the analysis as his own.

“That,” Dr. Elahi said, “is exactly what I wanted you to notice. Not that you asked for help structuring your ideas — every writer does that in some form. The problem is that a gap in your own understanding was hidden behind confident-sounding sentences that weren't really yours.”

She suggested that he rewrite section three independently, using only his own words, and that in future assignments, he disclose clearly which parts of his work had been shaped by AI tools and how. Tanvir agreed, somewhat relieved that the conversation had not ended more severely.

Walking out, he told Naeem what had happened. Naeem asked whether Tanvir now thought using AI for coursework was simply wrong. Tanvir considered this for a long moment. “I don't think it's that simple,” he said. “If I'd used it and still understood everything, and just said so honestly, I don't think it would have been a problem. The tool isn't really the issue. What I hid was.”

Naeem wasn't fully convinced. “Half the department uses these tools quietly,” he said. “If everyone declared it, would professors even have time to check everything properly? Isn't the whole policy sort of built on people not being fully honest about it?”

Tanvir didn't have an answer to that. He only knew that, for his own report, hiding the gap had cost him more than declaring it honestly would have.

SECTION 3 | VOCABULARY ZONE

Instructions: Study the words and collocations below. They are drawn from the Academic Word List and the theme of technology and academic ethics.

Word / Phrase	Part of Speech	Simple English Meaning	বাংলা অর্থ
plagiarism	noun	copying someone's work and presenting it as your own	চৌর্যবৃত্তি
transparency	noun	openness and honesty about facts or methods	স্বচ্ছতা
disclose	verb	to make known information that was hidden	প্রকাশ করা
integrity	noun	honesty and strong moral principles	সততা ও নৈতিক দৃঢ়তা
accountability	noun	being responsible and answerable for one's actions	জবাবদিহিতা
plausible	adjective	seeming reasonable or probably true	যুক্তিসঙ্গত মনে হয় এমন
undermine	verb	to weaken something gradually, often secretly	দুর্বল করে দেওয়া
deceive	verb	to intentionally make someone believe something false	প্রতারণা করা
justify	verb	to give good reasons for an action or decision	যুক্তি দিয়ে সমর্থন করা
dilemma	noun	a difficult choice between two options	উভয়সংকট

Word / Phrase	Part of Speech	Simple English Meaning	বাংলা অর্থ
inconsistency	noun	a lack of agreement between things that should match	অসঙ্গতি
legitimate	adjective	genuine and allowed by rules or reason	বৈধ / যুক্তিসঙ্গত
assisted	adjective	helped by a person or a tool	সহায়তাপ্রাপ্ত
a grey area	phrase	a situation without a clear right or wrong answer	অস্পষ্ট এলাকা (যেখানে ঠিক-ভুল স্পষ্ট নয়)
draw the line	phrase	to set a limit on what is acceptable	সীমা নির্ধারণ করা
in good faith	phrase	with honest and sincere intentions	সৎ উদ্দেশ্যে

Task A — Matching

Instructions: Match each word with its correct meaning. Write the letter in the Your Answer column.

Word	Your Answer
1. transparency	_____
2. undermine	_____
3. dilemma	_____
4. disclose	_____
5. inconsistency	_____
6. legitimate	_____

- A. to make known information that was hidden
- B. a difficult choice between two options
- C. genuine and allowed by rules or reason
- D. openness and honesty about facts or methods
- E. a lack of agreement between things that should match
- F. to weaken something gradually, often secretly

Task B — Fill in the Blanks

Instructions: Choose the best word from the box and complete the sentences.

Word Box: plagiarism | accountability | plausible | justify | assisted

- Submitting AI-generated text as entirely your own work can be considered a form of _____.
- Dr. Elahi wanted Tanvir to understand that using a tool does not remove his _____ for the final submission.
- Naeem's explanation of why Dr. Elahi called Tanvir in seemed entirely _____.
- Tanvir tried to _____ his choice by explaining that he understood the ideas already.
- An AI-_____ report can still reflect genuine understanding, if the student is honest about the process.

Task C — Vocabulary in Context

Instructions: Read each quotation from the story and guess the meaning of the underlined word from context.

1. "Intention did not remove the need for honesty." What does intention mean here?

2. "The problem is that a gap in your own understanding was hidden behind confident-sounding sentences." What does hidden mean in this context?

3. "If everyone declared it, would professors even have time to check everything properly?" What does declared mean here?

4. "She might have let a small change go unnoticed." What does unnoticed mean here?

5. "Half the department uses these tools quietly." What does quietly suggest about how the tools are used?

SECTION 4 | GRAMMAR DETECTIVE — Reported Speech & Modals of Speculation

Task A — Find from the Story

Instructions: Find and copy the required number of examples for each grammar focus from the story.

Grammar Focus	Examples from the Story
2 Reported Statements (with backshift)	
1 Reported Question	
1 Reported Advice / Suggestion	
Examples using suggested / insisted / denied / admitted	
2 Modals of Speculation (must have / might have)	
2 Modals of Deduction (can't have / should have)	

Task B — Grammar Lab

Instructions: For each sentence, identify the structure, explain why it is used, and write a similar sentence of your own.

1. *"She must have noticed something," Naeem said.*

Which grammar structure is used? _____

Why is it used? _____

Write a similar sentence: _____

2. *"You can't have expected a professor who reads forty reports a semester not to notice a sudden jump in vocabulary."*

Which grammar structure is used? _____

Why is it used? _____

Write a similar sentence: _____

3. *She explained that the problem was not necessarily the tool itself.*

Which grammar structure is used? _____

Why is it used? _____

Write a similar sentence: _____

4. *Naeem asked whether Tanvir now thought using AI for coursework was simply wrong.*

Which grammar structure is used? _____

Why is it used? _____

Write a similar sentence: _____

5. *She suggested that he rewrite section three independently, using only his own words.*

Which grammar structure is used? _____
Why is it used? _____
Write a similar sentence: _____

SECTION 5 | MIXED GRAMMAR CHALLENGE

A — Error Correction

Instructions: Each sentence contains one error in reported speech or a modal of speculation/deduction. Rewrite it correctly.

1. Dr. Elahi said that the problem “is” not necessarily the tool itself.

2. Naeem asked did Tanvir think using AI was wrong.

3. She must has noticed something unusual about the report.

4. He should have tell her from the start.

5. Tanvir denied that he cheat on the assignment.

B — Multiple Choice

Instructions: Choose the best answer: A, B, C, or D.

- Naeem said that she _____ noticed something odd.
A. must B. must have C. must to have D. must having Answer: _____
- Dr. Elahi explained that the problem _____ the tool itself.
A. is not necessarily B. was not necessarily C. not necessarily D. weren't necessarily Answer: _____
- Naeem asked _____ Tanvir thought using AI was wrong.
A. that B. if did C. whether D. what Answer: _____
- She suggested that he _____ section three independently.
A. rewrites B. will rewrite C. rewrite D. rewriting Answer: _____
- You _____ expected her not to notice such a big change.
A. can't have B. mustn't have C. shouldn't to have D. couldn't to have Answer: _____

C — Gap Fill

Instructions: Complete each sentence with the correct form of the word in brackets.

- Tanvir admitted that he _____ (use) an AI tool to help with the report.
- Naeem said that Tanvir _____ (should / tell) the professor from the start.
- Dr. Elahi asked whether Tanvir _____ (understand) the material fully.
- She suggested that he _____ (rewrite) the section on his own.
- Naeem said that professors _____ (might / not have) time to check everything if everyone disclosed AI use.

D — Sentence Transformation

Instructions: Rewrite each sentence as directed. Keep the meaning the same.

1. Original: Naeem said, “You must have made a mistake somewhere.”

Change to Reported Speech:

Naeem said that Tanvir _____.

2. Original: Dr. Elahi asked, “Did you write this section yourself?”

Change to Reported Speech:

Dr. Elahi asked whether Tanvir _____.

3. Original: Dr. Elahi said, “You should disclose your use of AI tools in future.”

Change to Reported Advice:

Dr. Elahi advised Tanvir _____.

SECTION 6 | SENTENCE BUILDER — Build Your Own Sentences

Instructions: Use each word or phrase to write one original sentence, following the required grammar structure exactly. Do not copy from the story.

Word / Phrase	Required Grammar Structure	Your Sentence
plagiarism	Reported statement (use 'admitted')	
disclose	Reported advice (use 'suggested')	
inconsistency	Modal of speculation (must have)	
legitimate	Reported question (use 'asked whether')	
draw the line	Modal of deduction (should have)	

SECTION 7 | SHORT WRITING TASK — Think & Write

Instructions: Write 150–180 words. Use at least two examples of reported speech and two modals of speculation or deduction. Write down the main paragraphs only.

Prompt:

Some people believe that students should be free to use AI tools for assignments as long as they understand the material. Others believe that any undisclosed use of AI undermines the purpose of assessment, regardless of understanding. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

Writing Space

SECTION 8 | CHARACTER REFLECTION — Character Corner

Instructions: These questions have no single correct answer. Discuss with a partner if possible, then write your own considered response.

1. Tanvir concludes, “The tool isn't really the issue. What I hid was.” To what extent do you agree that honesty about a process matters more than the process itself?

2. Naeem suggests that the whole disclosure policy might only function because most students do not fully comply with it. What does this reveal about rules that depend on individual honesty rather than enforcement?

3. Is there a meaningful difference between using a tool to organise understanding you already have, and using a tool to fill a gap in understanding you do not yet have? Where would you personally draw the line?

4. Dr. Elahi chose to ask Tanvir to explain the material aloud rather than accuse him directly. What does this approach suggest about how trust can be rebuilt after a mistake, rather than simply punished?

SECTION 9 | HOMEWORK

Level 1	Level 2
Write 6 sentences reporting things said in the story or in your own life, using reported speech or modals of speculation/deduction.	Write a reflective diary/essay entry (150–180 words) titled “A Time I Had to Decide Whether to Be Fully Honest.” Use at least 2 examples of reported speech and 2 modals of speculation or deduction.

Final Reminder: *A tool can assist your thinking, but it cannot take responsibility for it. Honesty about your process is what turns assistance into learning.*